

amBX in action

To watch how the amBX technology enhances game play for games like Mass Effect 2, head over to <http://bit.ly/pnaJ2>

Ukraine gets IMAXed

IMAX has teamed up with Ukraine's Triumph Media to install 5 IMAX theatres in the country, including 3 in the capital city of Kiev

Tomorrow's tech

provides both colour and disparity information. "Each lens overlapping 8 different points of view works as a magnifying lens, allowing for one only to be seen through the lens from any given angle. Because both eyes are not in the same place, they actually see two different points of view. This stereo effect produces a sensation of depth," explains the Alioscopy web site. Because each of those lenses have to be precisely aligned to cover each pixel, manufacturing them is not simple and they're not going to be cheap. Also, much of the content shown on these auto-stereoscopic screens is specially created. What about live-action? There is a company called 3D Eye Solutions that converts any footage into 3D to be viewed on an auto-stereoscopic screen. It even has set top boxes that can do it on the fly. This could mean 3D TV channels beamed in the near future.

But is depth perception enough? Real 3D would be when you can actually tilt your head and see a little of what's behind an object that's in your field of view. That would be something wouldn't it? Maybe holographic technology is the way to



go then. If Prof. Nasser Peyghambarian from the optical sciences department, university of Arizona has his way that could soon be a reality. Of course his screen, which is currently under development, is capable of refreshing itself in minutes while for a functional holo-tv we'd need it to refresh several times every second. Motion Parallax – the ability to change your point of view and view the image from that perspective – is the next horizon. This is still tomorrow's

tech so don't expect to see Princess Leia flickering in front of you anytime soon.

Get into the action

Immersive entertainment is an elusive dream. But manufacturers on the cutting edge of tomorrow's tech know that the only way to reach near-realism is to create as real an experience as possible for the five senses. Sight of course is taken care of quite well in the era of HD. But what about touch? There are companies that are doing just that. Take for instance TN Games that make the 3RD Space Vest. It's a jacket that when worn gives a new meaning to force feedback.

By way of an air compressor system (pneumatics) to inflate/deflate several specialised air pockets (or actuators) located through the vest the user feels the realistic impact from bullets and bone crunching physical contact in the game. The air pockets inflate and produce a physical strike against the user to produce the effects. Of course the intensity is not that of the actual strike but you get the

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